

MULTI-WEEK TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	June 29 — August 4, 2026 (~5 weeks)
Report Generated:	August 5, 2026
Trader:	James
Account:	LIVE (Schwab) + Shadow (Paper) + Futures (New)
Strategies:	SPX Bull Put Spreads Bear Call Spreads Iron Condors Futures (new)
Market:	FOMC Jul 29 (held, 3 dissenters wanted hike). Dow -1,153pts on Fed day. Iran surprise attack Jul 29 (oil +6.6%). MSFT +16%
Context:	James stepped back to focus on studying. Traded when time permitted. Reduced frequency, maintained quality.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: Live account +\$2,370 across 14 trades (85.7% win rate). Shadow account +\$10,985 across 13 new trades (92.3% win rate). Futures (new): -\$165 across 13 trades (61.5% win rate). Combined: +\$13,190. Zero errors on the options book. Every options trade tagged NONE for mistakes — the longest error-free period in the entire trading journey. The futures book contains one significant rule breach (F11, examined in its own section).

Studying took priority during this period. James traded an average of 3 trades per week on the live account compared to 4-5 previously. The reduced frequency did not reduce quality — in fact, it may have improved it. Less screen time, more selective entries, and the discipline to step away when conditions weren't right. The result: 85.7% win rate with only two small, managed losses.

Key Findings:

- 14 live trades, 12 wins, 2 losses. Zero errors. Longest clean streak in the journey.
- Live cumulative now +\$1,675 (recovered from -\$695 at end of June).
- BCS outperforming BPS: +\$1,585 from 5 BCS trades vs +\$835 from 8 BPS trades. Bear calls producing better returns per trade.
- Shadow trade S29: 30-lot BCS on Jul 27 for +\$5,100 — largest shadow win since Account 2. Conviction sizing working.
- Shadow ICs (S18-S21, S23): Five wide-wing ICs, all winners, +\$3,675. IC strategy validated at scale.
- Futures launched: 13 trades, 8W 5L, -\$165 net. Ex-F11 (the FOMC hold): +\$1,860. Scalping approach shows promise; rules need porting.
- FOMC Jul 29 navigated cleanly — calendar reminders working. No positions held through announcement.

LIVE ACCOUNT: +\$2,370 (14 Trades, 85.7% Win Rate)

#	Date	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Notes
203	29/06	IC	7600-7020	1	\$1.25	\$1.75	-\$50	Quarterlys. Small loss.
204	07/07	BCS	7545/7565	5	\$0.65	\$0.00	+\$325	Expired. Full premium.
205	09/07	BPS	7400/7380	5	\$0.65	\$0.30	+\$175	54% capture.
206	09/07	BPS	7405/7385	5	\$0.80	\$0.35	+\$225	56% capture.
207	13/07	BCS	7680/7700	5	\$0.75	\$0.35	+\$200	53% capture.
208	15/07	BPS	7530/7510	5	\$0.80	\$1.90	-\$550	4x stop. Clean.
209	17/07	BCS	7545/7565	3	\$1.10	\$0.00	+\$330	Expired. 100%.
210	21/07	BPS	7440/7420	5	\$0.65	\$0.00	+\$325	Expired. 100%.
211	22/07	BPS	7450/7430	4	\$0.85	\$0.15	+\$280	82% capture.
212	23/07	BCS	7480/7500	3	\$1.15	\$0.05	+\$330	96% capture.
213	24/07	BPS	7340/7320	5	\$0.65	\$0.55	+\$50	15%. Thin capture.
214	27/07	BCS	7570/7590	5	\$1.80	\$1.00	+\$400	44%. FOMC week.
215	29/07	BPS	7325/7305	5	\$0.90	\$0.60	+\$150	33%. FOMC day.

216	04/08	BPS	7650/7630	6	\$0.65	\$0.35	+\$180	Early close saved position.
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Strategy	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	P&L	Avg P&L
Bull Put Spread	8	7	1	87.5%	+\$835	+\$104
Bear Call Spread	5	5	0	100%	+\$1,585	+\$317
Iron Condor	1	0	1	0%	-\$50	-\$50
TOTAL	14	12	2	85.7%	+\$2,370	+\$169

BCS vs BPS: Bear call spreads produced +\$317 average per trade vs +\$104 for bull put spreads. BCS had 100% win rate vs 87.5% for BPS. The one BPS loss (-\$550 on trade 208) was a 4x stop that functioned correctly. The data across the live account now consistently shows bear calls outperforming on a per-trade basis — worth monitoring as a potential sizing signal.

Week	Dates	Trades	W/L	P&L
1	Jun 29	1	0W 1L	-\$50
2	Jul 7-9	3	3W 0L	+\$725
3	Jul 13-17	3	2W 1L	-\$20
4	Jul 21-24	4	4W 0L	+\$985
5	Jul 27-29	2	2W 0L	+\$550
6	Aug 4	1	1W 0L	+\$180

Week 4 (Jul 21-24) was the strongest: 4 trades, 4 wins, +\$985. Losses were small and contained when they occurred. No week produced more than -\$50 in losses.

LIVE ACCOUNT CUMULATIVE (All Time)

Period	Trades	Win %	P&L	Cumulative
Weeks 1-2 (May 6-20)	24	50%	-\$1,145	-\$1,145
Return (May 27-Jun 5)	9	100%	+\$3,070	+\$1,925
Post-Crash (Jun 8-10)	4	50%	-\$2,250	-\$325
FOMC Jun (Jun 15-18)	6	83%	+\$945	+\$620
Bearish Week (Jun 22-26)	4	25%	-\$1,315	-\$695
Study Period (Jun 29-Aug 4)	14	85.7%	+\$2,370	+\$1,675

Live account: +\$1,675 cumulative across 61 trades. The trajectory since the pause in late May has been consistently positive: +\$3,070, -\$2,250 (crash), +\$945, -\$1,315 (bearish week), +\$2,370. Net since the return: +\$2,820 across 37 trades with 78.4% win rate. The system is profitable on live money over a sustained period. *(Note: prior reports carried a cumulative table error double-counting the May pause week as -\$2,970; the correct figure for trades 155-178 is -\$1,145. All endpoint figures were unaffected. Corrected in this report.)*

SHADOW ACCOUNT: +\$10,985 (New Trades S18-S30)

#	Date	Type	Strikes	Cts	P&L	Notes
S18	25/06	IC	7585-7070	5	+\$900	Wide IC. Expired.
S19	25/06	IC	7535-7110	5	+\$525	Wide IC. 75% capture.
S20	25/06	IC	7560-7050	5	+\$650	Wide IC. Expired.
S21	25/06	IC	7600-7000	5	+\$850	Wide IC. Expired.
S22	22/06	Long Call	360C	5	-\$840	Speculative. Contained loss.
S23	29/06	IC	7610-7100	5	+\$750	Wide IC. Expired.
S24	13/07	BCS	717/718	100	+\$600	Comm drag. Not economic at scale.
S25	14/07	BPS	7450/7430	3	+\$150	Clean.
S26	14/07	BCS	7580/7600	5	+\$850	Expired. Strong premium.
S27	22/07	BPS	7390/7370	5	+\$550	Expired.
S28	27/07	BCS	7470/7490	5	+\$300	Clean.
S29	27/07	BCS	7570/7590	30	+\$5,100	30-lot conviction. Largest shadow win.
S30	29/07	BCS	7470/7490	5	+\$600	Expired.

Shadow Highlights:

- S29 (+\$5,100): 30-lot BCS on Jul 27. Conviction sizing at its best — clear bearish read on FOMC eve, \$1.80 premium, 94% capture. If this had been on the live account at current sizing (5 lots), it would have been +\$850.
- ICs (S18-S21, S23): Five wide-wing ICs, all winners, +\$3,675. Premium range \$1.30-\$1.80. All expired or closed near-zero. The IC strategy on shadow is now 10 wins from 10 IC trades across all time. Ready for careful live deployment.
- S24 (100-lot BCS): +\$600 but journal notes commission drag makes the structure uneconomic. Good data point for the minimum viable premium per contract.

FUTURES TRADING: FIRST 13 TRADES (-\$165)

James began trading futures on July 24. Thirteen trades across /NQ, /ES, and /MES (Nasdaq, S&P; full-size, and S&P; micros). 8 wins, 5 losses (61.5% win rate), net -\$165. All P&L; figures verified against points × \$/point × contracts — the log is arithmetically clean. Excluding one trade (F11, examined below), the futures book would be +\$1,860.

#	Date	Contract	Dir	Cts	Pts	P&L	Mins	Notes
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F1	24/07	/NQ	Long	1	+4	+\$80	0	First futures trade. Same-minute scalp.
F2	24/07	/ES	Short	1	+5.5	+\$275	3	3-min ES scalp.
F3	24/07	/ES	Short	2	-2	-\$200	12	Scaled short, covered flat.
F4	24/07	/MES	Long	1	-7.5	-\$37.50	11	First micro. Faded.
F5	27/07	/MES	Short	1	+6	+\$30	105	Bracket from pre-market. Longest hold.
F6	27/07	/MES	Short	10	+12.25	+\$612.50	16	Biggest point capture.
F7	28/07	/MES	Short	10	+4.25	+\$212.50	8	Bracket into US close.
F8	28/07	/MES	Short	20	-4.75	-\$475	34	Overlapped F9. 40 micros total.
F9	28/07	/MES	Short	20	+5.75	+\$575	7	Target leg filled.
F10	29/07	/MES	Short	20	-8	-\$800	9	Pre-FOMC chop.
F11	29/07	/MES	Short	20	-20.25	-\$2,025	46	HELD INTO FOMC. Largest loss.
F12	29/07	/MES	Long	20	+8	+\$800	2	Stop-and-reverse at print.
F13	04/08	/MES	Long	10	+15.75	+\$787.50	27	Best futures trade.

F11: The Options Rules Didn't Transfer

F11 held a 20-lot short micro position INTO the 2:00 PM ET FOMC announcement on July 29. The chain-linked exit fired on the announcement spike for -20.25 points: -\$2,025, the largest futures loss and larger than any options loss since the May pause. This is the exact risk that Rule 19 (no positions through binary catalysts) exists to prevent — a rule paid for with Trade 99's -\$138,750 on Account 2 and followed rigorously on options ever since. The calendar reminders fired that day; the options book was correctly flat through the announcement. The futures book was not. The framework exists in the options context but was not consciously applied to the new instrument. Every hard-won options rule needs explicit porting to futures: binary event flatness, notional position limits, stop discipline, and the cooling-off guideline.

F12: The Recovery — Skilled but Shouldn't Have Been Needed

One minute after F11's exit, James flipped long 20 lots at the announcement print and sold +8 points two minutes later for +\$800, recovering 40% of the F11 loss. The execution was genuinely skilled — reading the post-announcement direction and acting in seconds. But the situation only existed because F11 was held into the event. The pattern to guard against: a great recovery trade emotionally rewarding the original mistake.

Exposure Note: F8/F9 Overlap

F8 and F9 ran simultaneously — 40 micros of short exposure, approximately \$1.5M notional, on a ~\$50k account. Micros feel small per contract (\$5/point) but 40 lots is 2 full ES equivalents. A 20-point adverse move at that exposure is -\$4,000. Futures need an explicit notional cap the same way options have the 20% buying power reserve.

What the Futures Data Shows So Far:

- Scalping instinct is real: 8 of 13 trades were winners, most held under 30 minutes. F6 (+\$612.50 in 16 min) and F13 (+\$787.50 in 27 min) show genuine tape-reading ability.
- Sensible instrument progression: full-size ES/NQ first touches, then micros for size experimentation. The \$/point discipline (F4 onwards at \$5/pt) kept tuition costs low.
- Ex-F11 the book is +\$1,860: the approach works when the binary-event rule is respected. The single rule breach cost more than every other loss combined.
- Futures rules to formalise before scaling: (1) flat through all binary events, (2) notional cap per position and total, (3) no averaging into losers, (4) the 30-min cooling-off after any stop applies here too.

MARKET CONTEXT (5-Week Summary)

This period spanned significant macro events that tested the system:

Late June: Continued tech rotation from the Broadcom crash. SPX ranged 7,300-7,500. The two stop-outs from the prior week's report (trades 200-201) were the tail end of this move.

Early-Mid July: Markets stabilised. SPX traded 7,400-7,550. VIX settled into 15-18 range. This was the sweet spot for premium selling — enough premium to capture but not enough volatility to trigger noise stops. Trades 204-207, 209-213 all benefited

from this regime.

FOMC Week (Jul 27-29): Fed held rates at 3.50-3.75%. Three dissenters wanted to hike. Dow fell 1,153 points (worst since April 2025). Iran launched surprise attacks on US forces. Oil spiked 6.6%. 30-year yield hit 5.23% (highest since 2007). Trades 214-215 navigated this correctly — no positions held through announcement, premium captured on both sides.

Post-FOMC: Microsoft earnings +16% drove recovery. S&P; closed July at 7,489. Trade 216 on Aug 4 captured the post-recovery premium with an early close that saved the position from an unexpected reversal.

FRAMEWORK COMPLIANCE

Rule	Status	Notes
R2: 4x credit stop	TESTED ✓	Trade 208 stopped correctly. -\$550 managed loss.
R19: No binary catalysts	PASS ✓	FOMC Jul 29 navigated. Calendar reminders working. No positions through announcement.
R21: Min credit \$0.60	PASS ✓	All 14 trades at \$0.65-\$1.80. Well above floor.
R22: Verify flat	PASS ✓	No ghost trades across entire period.
Mistakes column	ALL NONE	14 consecutive clean trades. Longest error-free streak.

OBSERVATIONS

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ Reduced frequency, maintained quality: 14 trades in 5 weeks. Every one clean. Studying didn't degrade trading — it improved selectivity.
- ✓ BCS edge: 100% win rate, +\$317 avg per trade. Bear call spreads consistently outperforming bull puts.
- ✓ FOMC navigation: Calendar reminders fired. No positions held through. Trades 214-215 captured premium around the event.
- ✓ Trade 216 early close: Journal notes it saved the position from an unexpected reversal. Good instinct.
- ✓ Shadow ICs: 10/10 all-time win rate on iron condors. Structure validated for cautious live deployment.

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- **1. Futures Rules Porting:** F11 held 20 micros through FOMC — the exact breach Rule 19 prevents on options. Before any futures scaling: write the futures rulebook (binary event flatness, notional caps, stop discipline, cooling-off) and treat it with the same seriousness as the options framework.
- **2. Journal Reasoning:** James noted reasoning wasn't consistently logged during this period. The Market Context and Lessons Learned columns are what make the journal useful for post-analysis. Even a one-line thesis ("BEARISH 4/5, selling calls above resistance") adds significant value.
- **3. Shadow Simplification:** Two shadow accounts to be consolidated into one. Reduces operational overhead and simplifies reporting.
- **4. Live Sizing vs Shadow:** S29 at 30 lots made +\$5,100. The equivalent live trade (214) at 5 lots made +\$400. Same trade, same day, 12.75x difference. The conviction-to-size framework should inform when live can scale toward shadow levels.

CONCLUSION

+\$2,370 Live. +\$10,985 Shadow. Zero Errors. 85.7% Win Rate. This is the quietest, cleanest, and most consistently profitable period of the entire journey. Trading was secondary to studying, and the P&L; benefited. Fewer trades, better selection, complete framework compliance. The system doesn't need more trades to make money — it needs the right trades, executed cleanly.

Live Account: +\$1,675 Cumulative. 61 trades on real money. Profitable. Error rate zero across the last 37 options trades. The trajectory since the May pause: +\$2,820 on 37 trades at 78.4% win rate. This is the baseline the MSc work will formalise and the backtesting engine will validate. The futures book is the reminder that the framework lives in the trader, not the instrument: F11 broke on futures a rule that has been followed flawlessly on options since Trade 99 paid for it. Port the rules before scaling the size.

The MSc Starts Next Month. The foundation is laid: a proven SPX ODTE premium selling strategy, a 24-rule risk framework, a probability model, a market weather indicator in development, a backtesting prompt ready to execute, and now a live track record showing consistent profitability. The quantitative methods from the MSc will feed directly into model calibration, stop optimisation, and the eventual Angelrow Risk OS. Everything built over these 6 months connects.

